

SLAYVERSE – Series Bible

> *Prepared for development consideration. All materials original IP of Caleb Mills Stewart.*

1. Logline

When a reclusive Wyoming rancher discovers that the land beneath his cattle conceals the last open wound in the fabric of time – a wound his erased ancestors created – he must confront the family silence that buried his mother's name, or watch reality itself thin to nothing.

2. Series Overview

****SLAYVERSE**** is a cosmic western – not "space cowboys," but a story about a cowboy standing on cosmically contaminated ground. The genre is mythopunk temporal horror dressed in dust and silence: a rancher, a crack in time, and the centuries-long conspiracy of grief that put him on top of it. The tone lives at the intersection of regional mystery and existential dread – a place where fence posts hum at frequencies that shouldn't exist and the sunset bleeds a color no one in town can name.

The series enters the Slayverse – a sprawling mythology spanning twelfth-century knights, Venetian spies, Weimar occult scientists, drag matriarchs, and quantum cosmology – through its most grounded doorway: a ranch in the Powder River Basin, a man who won't talk about his mother, and something wrong under the land. Season 1 never leaves Wyoming for long. The cosmic horror is not alien invasion; it is the slow discovery that your grandfather went mad because he was sitting on a seam in reality, and now it's your turn to hold the line.

This is a show about inherited silence. About the things families bury that refuse to stay buried – because in the Slayverse, burial is just another word for delayed eruption. The mythology earns its strangeness by rooting every cosmic concept in a human wound. The universe is saved, if it is saved at all, by a man who finally says his mother's name out loud.

3. Comp Titles

****True Detective, Season 1**** – A regional mystery that implies a hidden cosmic order beneath the landscape. One damaged man carrying impossible knowledge, conducting an investigation that is really an exorcism. SLAYVERSE shares that architecture: the case is the land, the detective is the rancher, and the cult is a family that broke

time.

****Midnight Mass**** – Inherited dread. The sacred and the profane entangled so thoroughly that you can't save the community without confronting the thing it worships. SLAYVERSE applies this to a frontier family whose "faith" is silence about a mother no one will name, and whose "miracle" is a crack in reality they've been guarding for generations.

****The OA**** – A mythology that earns its strangeness by never apologizing for it. The body as cosmological instrument – movement, breath, and physical presence as the mechanism of transcendence. SLAYVERSE shares the conviction that the weird must be played straight, that audiences will follow you anywhere if the emotional logic holds.

****Deadwood**** – Frontier language and violence as moral philosophy. The show that proved a Western could be Shakespearean without losing the mud. SLAYVERSE inherits Deadwood's commitment to language as texture – the ranch scenes are written in the cadence of men who learned eloquence from loneliness.

****Yellowstone**** – The audience bridge. Land, legacy, and the weight of inheritance. Millions of viewers already understand the emotional vocabulary of a family ranch under threat. SLAYVERSE takes that vocabulary and contaminates it – what if the threat isn't developers or rival ranchers, but the seam in spacetime your grandfather tried to bury under the north pasture?

****Interstellar**** – Scale. The personal and the cosmic as the same wound. A father's love expressed through the physics of time. SLAYVERSE shares Nolan's conviction that the biggest possible story is always, finally, about one person trying to get home to someone they love. In our case: a man trying to honor a mother he never met.

4. Thematic Statement / "Why Now"

We live in the age of the Mandela Effect – not because millions of people are misremembering the Berenstain Bears, but because the shared story engine of consensus reality has started to misfire. When competing media regimes, algorithmic feeds, state propaganda, and platform incentives collide, ordinary people experience reality itself as **versioned**: patches applied, facts rearranged, memories hotfixed without a changelog.

Post-truth is what happens when facts survive but the stage that made them collectively believable burns down.

The Slayverse is the symbolic container for that collapse. It is a cosmology built for a world in which shared reality has already cracked – a universe where the fracture isn't metaphorical, it's literal, and the people tasked with holding it together aren't

chosen ones blessed by prophecy. They're damaged, exhausted, and operating with incomplete instructions.

This is not Harry Potter. There is no sorting hat, no benevolent headmaster, no inherited destiny that flatters you into heroism. The Slayverse distinction is this: the mythology doesn't comfort you with a hidden order that was always working in your favor. It confronts you with a hidden *wound* that was always working beneath your feet – and asks whether you have the courage to grieve it openly rather than guard it in silence.

The mission statement, spoken by the Weaver to no one in particular:

> *"Shit's weird, man. It's kind of fucked up around here. But here's Carl Jung in drag doing a death drop in 1940s Berlin."*

That's the show. The weird is real. The damage is real. And the response – across centuries, across genders, across every form of erasure power can devise – is transformation performed so fiercely that it becomes cosmological fact. Lesser cosmologies fling souls into volcanoes. Ours scatters divas through history and makes them improvise.

****Why now?*** Because the audience that once found comfort in chosen-destiny fantasy has grown up in a world where the hidden order turned out to be an algorithm, the prophecy turned out to be a marketing funnel, and the magic school turned out to be run by someone who hates them. They are hungry for a mythology that doesn't lie about the mess – that meets them in the post-truth wreckage and says: *the fracture is real, the grief is real, and the only repair is the thing you were too afraid to say out loud.*

5. The World

The Slayverse operates on a simple cosmological premise with enormous narrative implications:

****In the late nineteenth century, a group of European researchers at the Federstahl Institute attempted to trap time in solid form.**** They used crystalline lattice structures and exotic minerals to stabilize tachyon particles – particles that move backward through time. They succeeded. And it screamed.

The resulting catastrophe – the ****Federstahl Lattice Incident**** – was not merely a laboratory explosion. It was an *ontological deletion event*: it erased the researchers from the sanctioned record of existence and scattered them across history as temporal anomalies. Seven wounds – ****fissures**** – tore open across the globe, each a seam where time bleeds through.

The displaced researchers didn't simply die or relocate. They were *annulled* – removed from the historical record as if they had never

been born. Their knowledge, their identities, their unfinished purposes were dispersed across centuries. This scattering is called the ****temporal diaspora****: the persistence of erased beings, each carrying broken portions of secret knowledge and forced to translate that knowledge into whatever form their receiving era permits – art, ritual, resistance, drag.

What later appears as the ****Von Hooplehopper soul-line**** – a seemingly continuous "family" of extraordinary individuals across eight centuries – is actually this diaspora in motion. The Hooplehoppers are not a dynasty. They are a frequency. A pattern of resistant being that recurs whenever the world teeters too far toward erasure, cruelty, or silence. *Blood reproduces. The soul-line recurs.*

Binding them together is ****the Thread**** – a cosmic force that is both literal (the Weaver manipulates it) and metaphorical (the narrative connection between all displaced souls). The Thread chooses vessels not by heredity but by heartbreak, by endurance, by refusal.

Of the seven fissures created by the Lattice Incident, six have been claimed, sealed, or lost. ****The Wyoming Rift**** – buried beneath a cattle ranch in the Powder River Basin – is the last one open. And the man sitting on top of it has no idea what he's guarding.

6. Season 1 Arc

Pilot Synopsis – "The Wound Under the Prairie"

Wind over dry grass. A ranch that should have been sold years ago. Cattle that won't graze in the north pasture. A fence post that hums when the temperature drops below freezing.

Jake McCullen works his land alone. His grandfather – Pop – went mad here, and everyone in the county knows it. What they don't know is why: the unmarked graves on the ranch's north boundary, the crystal fragment buried beneath the root cellar, the strange light that appears at 2:17 a.m. and lasts exactly twelve minutes.

Jake knows. He's known since he was fourteen and found Pop singing to a rock that glowed. He has spent his adult life containing the knowledge – patching fences, burying evidence, and refusing to speak about any of it. Especially about his mother. The woman who died before he ever saw her face. The woman Pop mentioned exactly zero times.

Then the Weaver arrives. Gloved, veiled, unhurried. Speaking in a cadence that doesn't belong to Wyoming or any century Jake recognizes. The Weaver knows about the fissure. The Weaver knows about Pop. The Weaver knows the name Jake has never heard spoken aloud – his mother's name.

And the Weaver tells Jake what he has spent his entire life refusing to hear: that the land isn't haunted. It's wounded. That the wound was made by Jake's own ancestors. That Jake isn't the victim of a family curse – he is the last living key to repairing a fracture in the structure of time itself.

****Save the prairie mother, save the universe.****

The pilot ends with Jake holding a photograph he found beneath Pop's floorboards – a woman in a cotton dress, standing in the north pasture, smiling at someone behind the camera. On the back, in Pop's handwriting: a name. The name no one ever said.

Episode Arc Shape

The season traces Jake's progression through four emotional phases, each spanning roughly two to three episodes:

1. ****Denial**** – Jake treats the Weaver as a trespasser, the fissure as geological, and the family history as none of anyone's business. ***"Cosmic fabric? Sounds like the same bullshit Indians used to sing over their campfires."***
2. ****Confrontation**** – Evidence accumulates that can't be explained away. The brand on Jake's yearling is revealed as a Federstahl cipher. Missing time incidents increase. Jake grabs the Weaver by the throat and slams him against the corral fence: ***"You don't get to talk about my mother."***
3. ****Revelation**** – Pop's secret unfolds. The singing. The buried crystal. The failed attempts to open "ribbon gates" – the unmarked graves. Jake breaks: ***"I branded them all, thinking I could trap the madness in the skin... But I branded myself most of all."***
4. ****Grief Spoken Aloud**** – Jake speaks his mother's name. For the first time in the McCullen line, the silence breaks. The fissure responds. The season ends not with cosmic fireworks, but with a man kneeling in dry grass, saying a name into the wind, and the wind carrying it somewhere it was always meant to go.

7. Character Breakdowns (Season 1)

Jake McCullen – The Reluctant Legacy-Bearer

****Essence****: A frontier custodian whose guardianship is not heroism but containment – the shadow logic of a dead research institute dressed in dust and denim, aimed at a crack in reality rather than a laboratory instrument.

****Arc****: Denial → rage → confession → grief spoken aloud. Jake begins the season as a man who has successfully converted an

existential crisis into ranch chores. He ends it as a man who has said his mother's name and can't take it back.

****The Vorst-Adjacent Ambiguity****: Jake is not a member of the soul-line. He is a counter-lineage figure – a descendant of Doctor Vorst, the man who **caused** the catastrophe. His bloodline is not one of recurrence but of erasure's aftermath: what remains when history burns away the lab, the title, and the certainty, leaving only duty, damage, and a gun pointed at the seam in reality. This gives Jake a deliberate moral ambiguity: does he protect the fissure from exploitation, or the world from its truths?

****Core Wound****: His mother died before he ever saw her face. Pop never spoke of her. The silence is the shape of the Vorst catastrophe in Jake's life – an ontological deletion made intimate, made domestic, made unbearable.

****Key Scene****: Jake grabs the Weaver by the throat, slams him against the corral fence, and snarls: **"You don't get to talk about my mother."** It is the most honest thing he has said in twenty years.

The Weaver – The Mysterious Arrival

****Essence****: Part prophet, part provocateur, part uninvited therapist. A figure who operates simultaneously inside the story and outside it – the narrator who has stepped through the fourth wall and landed in Wyoming.

****Arc****: The Weaver arrives knowing more than Jake, but not everything. Over the season, the Weaver discovers that knowing the cosmology is not the same as understanding the wound. The Weaver's journey is from architect to witness – from "I will show you the truth" to "I will sit with you while you grieve it."

****Dual Role****: Within the story, the Weaver is a mysterious stranger who arrives at the ranch with impossible knowledge. At the meta-narrative level, the Weaver represents the creator who has realized he is Bastian from **The NeverEnding Story** – the reluctant narrator who doesn't realize he's in the story until he has spoken it into existence.

****Key Line****: **"You are not a descendant. You are the loom. And the cosmos is ready to be hemmed."**

Pop – The Cursed Patriarch

****Essence****: A man who tried to contain a wound in spacetime with whiskey, ritual, and brute silence – and was consumed by it.

****Arc**:** Pop appears exclusively in flashback and memory. His presence is architectural – he is the shape of the silence Jake inherited. Each flashback reveals a layer: the madness, the singing, the failed experiments, the graves. The final flashback – Pop kneeling beside baby Jake's crib, whispering the mother's name like a prayer – reframes every act of silence as a failed attempt at love.

****Key Detail**:** Pop didn't scream when the crystal shard took him. He sang. Low and broken. Like he wanted it to carry him back to Jake's mother.

****Key Revelation**** (Season 1 climax): The Weaver tells Jake: *"He sang at your naming. Broke down on his knees beside your crib and whispered her name like a prayer. Every damn day until you were five."* Jake: *"Bullshit. He never mentioned her once."* Weaver: *"That was the only way he knew to protect you."*

Eli McCullen – The Future-Generation Hook

****Essence**:** Jake's grandson. A teenager who doesn't yet know what he is – but the land already knows him.

****Arc**:** Eli is a Season 1 presence, not a Season 1 protagonist. He visits the ranch. He hears things Jake doesn't want him to hear. He puts his hand on the ground above the buried crystal, and something in his blood *answers*. His arc in Season 1 is limited to three beats: arrival, suspicion, and a single moment of involuntary connection with the fissure that terrifies Jake into action.

****The Promise**:** *"Thunder in his bones"* isn't metaphor – it's the hum of the lattice calling out to descendants through blood resonance. Eli carries the encoded legacy that Pop may have buried in the family's DNA. He is the reason the story doesn't end with Jake – the next generation's burden and possibility.

****Key Line**** (spoken by the Weaver, about Eli): *"He won't tame these ridges, though he'll try. He'll ride with thunder in his bones."*

VUORSE – Framing Narrator / Cosmic Voice

****Essence**:** The soul-line's current active vessel. A cosmic drag oracle who narrates the Wyoming horror from a position of deep knowledge and devastating wit. She is the audience's bridge between Jake's grounded frontier silence and the Slayverse's deeper mythological architecture.

****Role in Season 1**:** VUORSE does not appear as a physical character in the Wyoming timeline. She is the framing narrator – voiceover,

interstitial commentary, and occasional direct address. Her register is knowing, warm, and ruthless: she cares about Jake, but she is not sentimental about his pain. She has seen this pattern before. She has **been** this pattern before.

****The Tonal Function**:** VUORSE's narration prevents the show from collapsing into grim prestige bleakness. She is the cosmic perspective that reminds the audience – and Jake – that the wound is real, the grief is real, and also: this is a universe where a man in a mirrored caftan once brought a Venetian duke to his knees with a well-timed wink. The sublime and the ridiculous are the same frequency.

****Key Line**:** *"Oh my sweet windswept whisper of a man... Jake never knew he was sitting on a wrinkle in the weave. That's the thing about cowboys, darling – some of them are just gatekeepers with six-shooters."*

8. Season Arc Roadmap

Season 1 – "The Wound Under the Prairie"

Wyoming as local mystery, temporal horror, and inherited guardianship. The story never leaves the ranch for long. The horror is domestic: a family that broke time and then refused to talk about it. The emotional spine is the unnamed mother – the woman erased from the McCullen record just as Doctor Vorst was erased from the Federstahl record. The season ends when Jake says her name.

Season 2 – "The Institute Remains"

The world opens. The Federstahl Institute – what remains of it – comes into focus. Doctor Vorst's story unfolds: architect of catastrophe, erased victim, ancestor, lingering echo. The crystal shard buried under the ranch is revealed as one fragment of a larger lattice, and other fissures around the world are stirring. Jake is pulled from the ranch into a broader conflict with the controlling logic that made his family collateral damage. Berlin. The bombed cathedral where the last Federstahl gathering was held in 1945. The pipe organ that still hums the encoded knowledge.

Season 3+ – "The Soul-Line Across Eras"

The soul-line opens fully. The show's temporal scope expands: mirrors, drag histories, recursive cosmology, the Von Hooplehopper lineage across eight centuries. The NeverEnding Story recursion completes – the Weaver fully realizes that creating the Slayverse was never separate from living inside it. The audience sees Carl Jung in drag doing a death drop in wartime Berlin. The audience sees a twelfth-century knight vanish into a mirror and emerge in a Venetian corset shop. The audience sees VUORSE – not as voiceover, but as a character in her own right, the culmination of everything

the lineage has been building toward.

The promise of the later seasons: this was never just a Western. This was always a story about what survives when everything that defines you is erased – and the answer, across every century, is *performance, resistance, and the refusal to be silent.*

9. Format & Tone Notes

****Episode Length****: 50–60 minutes. The show needs room to breathe – silence is a storytelling instrument, not dead air. The Wyoming scenes in particular should resist the urge to fill every frame with dialogue. When Jake is alone on the ranch, the audience should feel the quiet that he has been using as armor.

****Visual Language****: Dust. Silence. Strange light. The sublime without leaving the ranch. The camera should treat the Wyoming landscape the way Malick treats Texas and Villeneuve treats the desert – as a character with its own emotional weather. When the fissure is active, the visual distortion should be subtle: a horizon line that bends slightly wrong, a shadow that falls in the wrong direction, grass that moves against the wind. The audience should feel it before they see it.

****The "Adjacent to the Cosmos" Western Aesthetic****: This is not a sci-fi show. There are no spaceships, no energy beams, no holographic displays. The cosmic elements manifest through the landscape itself – light, sound, temperature, the behavior of animals, the hum of the buried crystal. The fissure is felt, not seen. When the Weaver reveals the cosmos to Jake (the starfield behind him), it is the single moment of overt spectacle in the pilot – and it should feel like a violation of the show's own rules, which is exactly how Jake experiences it.

****VUORSE's Narration Register****: Warm. Knowing. Occasionally devastating. She speaks the way someone speaks who has watched this story play out across centuries and still finds it moving. Her narration should feel like a late-night conversation with someone who loves you enough to tell you the truth – not cruelty, but clarity delivered with a wink and the faintest suggestion that she's seen worse, honey, and the universe survived that too.

****Score****: Sparse. Acoustic guitar, cello, wind. The score should sound like the land remembering something it would rather forget. When the fissure is present, a low-frequency hum – almost inaudible, felt in the chest – threads beneath the music. VUORSE's narration segments can carry a different sonic texture: warmer, slightly reverberant, as if her voice is coming from inside a very large, very beautiful room that doesn't exist in Wyoming.

The Slayverse is what happens when Field of Dreams grows up, gets hit by temporal catastrophe, and starts doing drag.

L. Ron Hubbard gave you space opera neurosis. Slayverse gives you temporal diaspora in heels.

Save the prairie mother, save the universe.